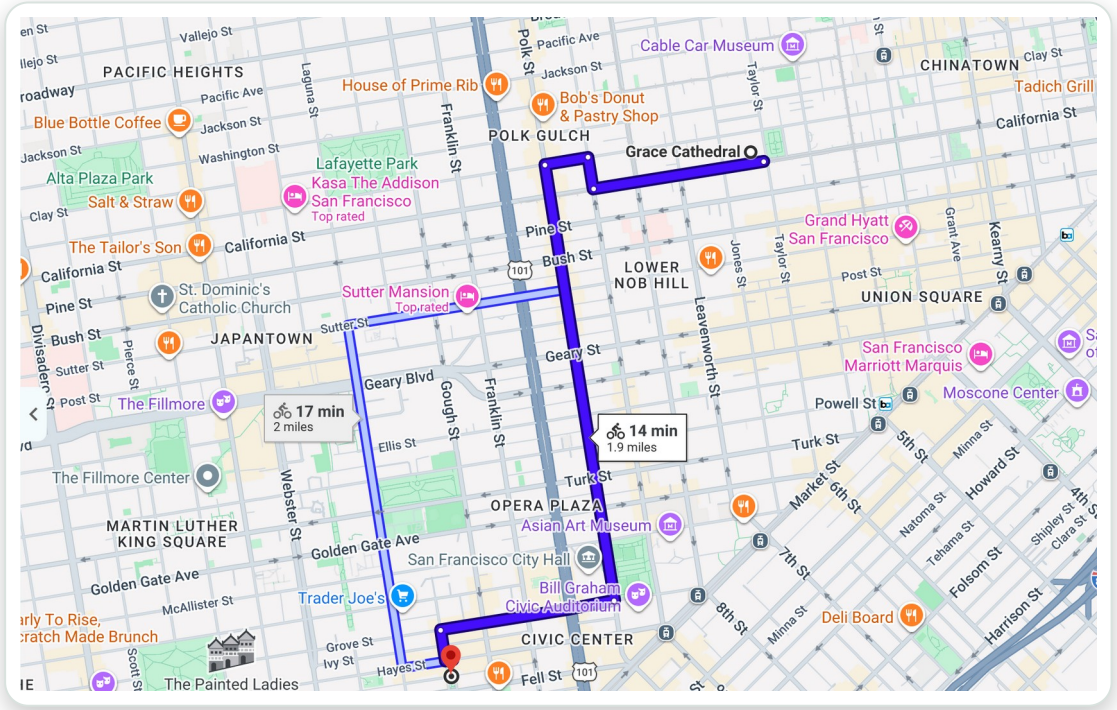
Google's bike route rides past the Tenderloin

…and straight through Civic Center. Same trip: Grace Cathedral → Patricia's Green, Hayes Valley

Google Maps · bicycling · 14 min, 1.9 mi



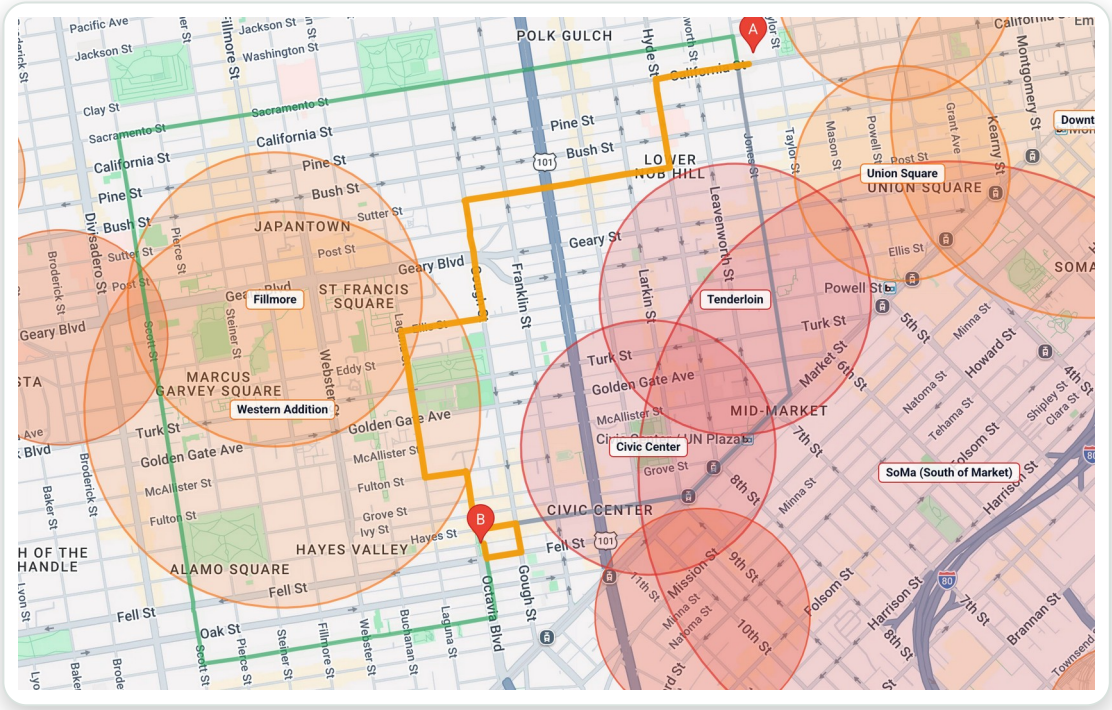
39%

of the ride inside Severe areas: Civic Center 0.5 mi, Tenderloin 0.2 mi

67%

with no protected bike lane (only parts of Polk St are protected)

BetterRoutes · Safest · 22 min, 2.1 mi



0%

inside Severe areas, and it avoids every crash hotspot

−25%

average street danger vs our fastest route, for +5 min

More than safety: real SF data, shaped by you

Avoid hills
Data: USGS elevation at 112,492 points on the street map

21.8% → 8.6%

steepest climb; climbing 1,027 → 518 ft, and 7 min quicker
Try it: Ocean Beach → Ferry Building, Safest

Fewer traffic lights
Data: 1,314 SFMTA traffic signals

35 → 12 lights

Fastest 35, Safest 17, Safest + Fewer lights 12 (2 min quicker than Safest)
Try it: Ocean Beach → Ferry Building

Honest ride time
Data: Every estimate counts each climb and ~12 s per red light

Fastest ≤ Safest

Because times include hills and lights, "Fastest" is never slower than a safer option — checked by automated tests
Try it: Any trip: compare the Est. time on each route

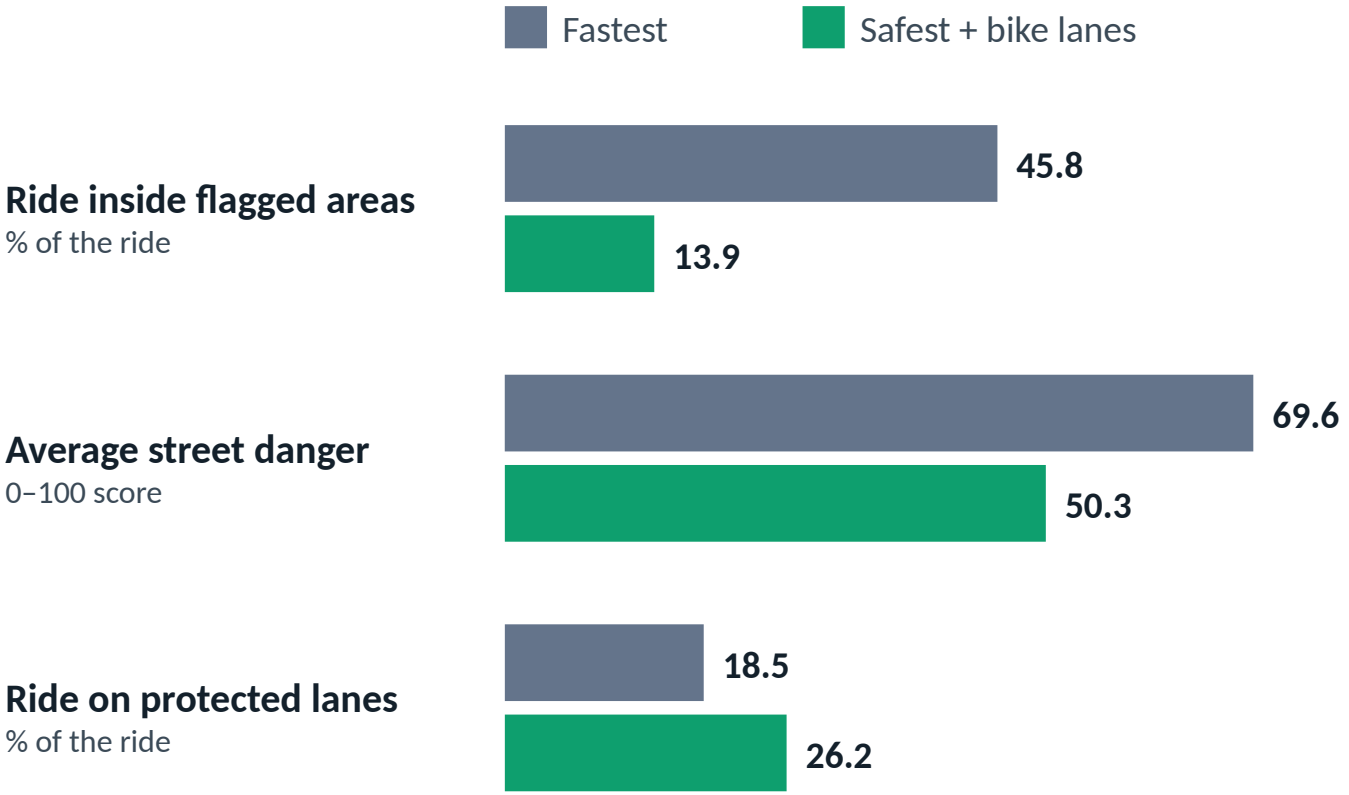
Customize with AI
Data: Same controls you use, plus 3,712 real places

1 sentence

"Flat ride please, with boba and a park on the way" → a For you ride, 5.4 mi, 2 stops
Try it: Noe Valley → North Beach

Danger scores come from our trained model; hills, lights and ride time come straight from measured city data.

Safer routes cut time in flagged areas by 70%



−70%
time spent inside flagged areas

7 → 1
of 10 trips enter a Severe area

−28%
average street danger; 1.4× protected lanes

+33%
ride time — the honest cost, shown on every route

10 trips typed into the app (first address suggestion), averaged per trip, Oct 14, 2026. Full list in the appendix.

Appendix: where every number comes from

Number in the deck	Source	Show it live (From → To, as typed)
1,103 cyclists killed, 52,887 injured (US, 2024)	NHTSA Traffic Safety Facts, 2024 Data: Bicyclists	—
4% of SF street miles hold 55% of severe/fatal bike injuries	SFMTA Vision Zero High Injury Network (cyclist corridors)	Neighborhood view on any trip
About half of big-city adults want to bike but worry about safety	Dill & McNeil, Transportation Research Record 2587 (2016)	—
Google route: 39% in Severe areas, 67% unprotected	Google Maps bicycling directions, captured Oct 14, 2026; SFMTA bike-network data	Grace Cathedral → Patricia's Green
−70% flagged, −28% danger, 1.4× lanes, +33% time, 7→1 of 10	BetterRoutes, 10 trips (next slide)	Any trip on the next slide
Danger 62 → 32, protected 11% → 53%, +26 min	BetterRoutes, Safest + bike lanes vs Fastest	Ocean Beach → Ferry Building
Steepest 21.8% → 8.6%, climbing 1,027 → 518 ft, −7 min	BetterRoutes, Safest with Avoid hills off/on	Ocean Beach → Ferry Building
Traffic lights 35 → 17 → 12	BetterRoutes: Fastest / Safest / Safest + Fewer traffic lights	Ocean Beach → Ferry Building
3,558 crashes · 5,455 lane segments · 5,566 highways · 1,314 signals	DataSF crashes 2019+; SFMTA bike network & signals; OpenStreetMap	lib/data/*.json in the repo
211,221 street segments · 3,712 places · 177,023 buildings	OpenStreetMap; DataSF building footprints (LiDAR)	3D tour shows the building count
411 automated tests, all passing	Vitest suite in the repo	npm test

Appendix: the 10 trips behind the results

From → To (as typed)	Fastest: in flagged areas	Safest + lanes: in flagged areas	Danger	Protected lanes	Time
Ocean Beach → Ferry Building	23.9%	0%	62.1 → 31.9	10.6% → 53.1%	70 → 96 min
Pacific Heights → Mission Street & 17th Street	53.7%	54%	74.6 → 56.8	1.5% → 27.2%	25 → 42 min
Marina Green → Dolores Park	27.2%	17.1%	56.6 → 45.3	0.9% → 18.3%	37 → 43 min
Noe Valley → North Beach	45.2%	14.5%	71 → 48.5	32.9% → 1.3%	43 → 53 min
Grace Cathedral → Hayes Valley	78.3%	0%	88.6 → 69.9	11.8% → 8.4%	15 → 17 min
Chinatown → Dolores Park	58.1%	14.6%	74.1 → 67	39.2% → 19.7%	34 → 41 min
Union Square → Lower Haight	57.2%	13.5%	74 → 68	30.2% → 1.7%	21 → 30 min
Clement Street & 6th Avenue → Potrero Hill	36.8%	12.7%	66.6 → 49.4	4.2% → 12.5%	53 → 66 min
Marina Green → Potrero Hill	47.3%	12.7%	63.6 → 34.7	33.7% → 65%	55 → 72 min
Golden Gate Park → Ferry Building	29.8%	0%	65.3 → 31.9	20.2% → 54.9%	56 → 84 min

Pick the first address suggestion. "Safest + lanes" is the app's "Safest + bike lanes" option. Measured Oct 14, 2026.